



ROUTEUP CAREER GUIDANCE SERIES — VOLUME 6

Visa Interviews and Rejections

Why Students Get Refused — and How Not To Be One of Them

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The Refusal Numbers Are Real

In 2025–26, refusal rates for Indian student applicants reached roughly 60%+ for the USA, around 40% for Australia (a 21-year high), and 38–45% for Canada. Germany, by contrast, refuses only 12–18%. These numbers are not meant to frighten you — they are meant to convince you that visa preparation is not a formality.

Myth: “Rejection is bad luck.”

Reality: Refusal letters cite reasons, and the same five appear over and over: weak finances, generic purpose statements, misaligned academics, missing documents, and unconvincing answers about intent. Every one of them is preventable.

Myth: “An agent's 'visa guarantee' protects me.”

Reality: No private person influences a government decision. A 'guarantee' is a marketing word — read the fine print and you'll usually find it guarantees only a refund of THEIR fee, not your application fees, not your lost intake, not your lost year.

Myth: “If refused, my file is ruined forever.”

Reality: You can reapply — and reapplications that genuinely fix the cited reasons succeed at an estimated 60–70%. What ruins files is reapplying with the same weaknesses, or worse, with 'improved' fake documents.

The Five Killers, and Their Fixes

- **1. Financial documentation** — sudden deposits, unclear sponsors, bare-minimum funds. Fix: 6-month organic history, documented sponsor relationship, 20–30% buffer. (Full method in Volume 3.)
- **2. Purpose and intent** — Australia's Genuine Student requirement and its equivalents demand a specific answer to 'why this course, why this country, why not India?' 'Australia has good universities' fails. 'This specialisation isn't offered at comparable depth in India, and here is my career plan needing it' passes.
- **3. Academic misalignment** — a commerce graduate applying to a nursing course without explanation reads as a visa purchase, not a study plan. Fix: the straight-line rule from Volume 4, and if your line genuinely bends, explain the bend honestly and concretely.
- **4. Documents** — expired, missing, unstamped, unapostilled. Fix: official checklist, second-person verification. (Volume 5.)
- **5. English** — if the admission required English scores you didn't submit, or your interview English collapses under simple questions, refusal follows. Fix: never skip the test prep, and rehearse answering aloud — about YOUR course, YOUR funding, YOUR plan.

If the interview comes

Interviews (especially US F-1) are short and decided fast. Know your course content, your total costs, your funding source, and your post-study plan — in your own words, without reciting. Officers are trained to detect memorised scripts; a hesitant honest answer beats a fluent recited one.

What consultancies won't tell you: some agents respond to a refusal by suggesting a 'stronger file' — meaning fabricated documents. A refusal is recoverable; a fraud finding is not. If anyone proposes editing your financials or history, walk away that day.

Worksheet — Refusal-Proofing

- ☐ I can explain in 60 seconds, without notes: why this course, why this country, why not India
- ☐ My finances pass the Volume 3 tests (organic history + buffer)

- ☐ My academic line is straight, or my bend has an honest, documented explanation
 - ☐ My document checklist is verified against the official source by a second person
 - ☐ I have rehearsed interview answers aloud, in English, about my specific plans
 - ☐ The refusal reason I am most at risk of: _____
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When to Get Help

Everything in this volume you can act on yourself — that is deliberate. But the worksheet you just filled has answers only YOU could write, and validating those answers against real requirements, real budgets, and real immigration rules is where mistakes hide.

Bring your completed refusal-proofing checklist to session with RouteUp. We will go through it line by line and tell you honestly — including if your plan is fine and you don't need us further.

Book your free session: www.routeup.co.in · hello@routeup.co.in ·

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